

90-Day Professional Assessment

GovCon BD Upskilling Certification — Final Exam

Assessment Overview

- **Questions:** 20 multiple-choice (complex scenarios)
- **Time Limit:** 60 minutes
- **Passing Score:** 80% (16 correct)
- **Format:** 85% scenario-based, 15% strategic application
- **Prerequisites:** Completion of 30-Day Foundation and 60-Day Practitioner
- **Focus:** Cross-functional leadership, capture execution, strategic BD, organizational growth

Note: This assessment includes multi-step scenarios and strategic decision-making questions that require synthesis of all program content.

Instructions:

Read each scenario carefully. These questions test your ability to lead BD activities, make strategic decisions, and coordinate cross-functional efforts.

Section A: Strategic Pipeline & Portfolio Management (Questions 1-5)

Question 1 (Executive Scenario)

Your company has \$50M in annual revenue and a current qualified pipeline of \$100M. Leadership wants to grow to \$75M in revenue within 2 years. Your win rate is 25%. What pipeline value do you need to achieve the growth target?

- A. \$100M (current pipeline is sufficient)
- B. \$300M in qualified pipeline (\$75M target ÷ 25% win rate)
- C. \$150M (just add 50% more)
- D. \$500M (aim as high as possible)

Your Answer:

Question 2 (Portfolio Analysis)

You're reviewing your company's pipeline portfolio. 70% of opportunities are with a single agency (DHS), and 80% are in a single NAICS code. What risk does this represent, and what should you recommend?

- A. No risk—specialization is a competitive advantage
- B. Concentration risk—recommend diversifying across agencies and service lines to reduce dependency
- C. This is ideal—focus resources on your strength
- D. Only diversify NAICS, not agencies

Your Answer:

Question 3 (Resource Allocation)

Your BD team can only actively pursue 5 opportunities this quarter. You have 12 in the pipeline. How should you prioritize?

- A. Choose the 5 largest by contract value
- B. Score opportunities by Pwin, strategic fit, resource requirements, and timing—pursue the top 5 with highest weighted scores
- C. Choose randomly to avoid bias
- D. Pursue all 12 with less effort on each

Your Answer:

Question 4 (Strategic Decision)

Your CEO asks whether to pursue a \$200M opportunity that would double company revenue if won. Your company has never won a contract larger than \$30M. What analysis should you present?

- A. Recommend immediate pursuit—big wins drive growth
- B. Present a risk-benefit analysis: execution risk, past performance gap, teaming requirements, and investment needed vs. strategic upside
- C. No-bid automatically—it's too big
- D. Wait for the RFP before analyzing

Your Answer:

Question 5 (Metrics)

Your BD team has a 20% win rate, while industry average is 30%. Your CEO asks why. Which metric should you examine FIRST?

- A. Total number of proposals submitted
- B. Bid/no-bid discipline—are you pursuing opportunities where you have competitive advantage?
- C. Proposal formatting and graphics
- D. Number of BD staff

Your Answer:

Section B: Complex Capture Leadership (Questions 6-10)

Question 6 (Multi-Stakeholder Scenario)

You're leading capture for a \$75M opportunity. The technical team wants to propose an innovative cloud solution. The contracts team is concerned about risk. The pricing team says it will be 15% higher than competitors. As capture lead, how do you resolve this?

- A. Override everyone and choose the approach you prefer
- B. Facilitate a solution session to find a balanced approach that addresses technical innovation, contractual risk mitigation, and price competitiveness
- C. Escalate to the CEO for a decision
- D. Remove the innovation to reduce price

Your Answer:

Question 7 (Teaming Negotiation)

You're negotiating a teaming agreement with a potential partner. They want 40% of the work share, but your analysis shows 25% is appropriate based on their contribution. They're threatening to team with your competitor instead. What's your approach?

- A. Accept 40% to avoid losing them
- B. Present objective analysis of work share based on PWS requirements, and negotiate to a fair split—but walk away if terms don't make business sense
- C. End negotiations immediately
- D. Agree to 40% now and renegotiate after award

Your Answer:

Question 8 (Customer Intelligence)

Through multiple touchpoints, you've gathered conflicting information about customer priorities. The Program Manager emphasizes cost savings. The end users want better performance. The CIO wants modernization. How do you incorporate this into your capture strategy?

- A. Focus only on what the Program Manager wants—they're the decision-maker
- B. Develop a solution that addresses all three priorities with clear messaging for each stakeholder, showing how they interconnect
- C. Ignore the conflicts and propose a generic solution
- D. Ask the customer to clarify their priorities in writing

Your Answer:

Question 9 (Capture Review)

At a Gate 3 review (final go/no-go before proposal), your Pwin assessment is 35%—below your company's 40% threshold. However, this is a strategic customer you want to build a relationship with. What do you recommend?

- A. No-bid—rules are rules
- B. Present the strategic rationale for an exception: relationship-building value, follow-on potential, and acceptable loss investment—let leadership make an informed decision
- C. Inflate the Pwin score to get approval
- D. Bid but don't invest full resources

Your Answer:

Question 10 (Crisis Management)

Two weeks before proposal submission, your key technical writer quits. Your backup is on another critical proposal. What's your recovery plan?

- A. Request a proposal extension from the government
- B. Implement contingency: redistribute writing assignments, bring in contract support, extend team hours, and brief leadership on risk and mitigation
- C. Submit what you have and hope for the best
- D. No-bid the opportunity

Your Answer:

Section C: Cross-Functional Coordination & Organizational BD (Questions 11-15)

Question 11 (Organization-Wide BD)

Your company wants to shift from a “BD team does everything” model to an “everyone supports growth” model. As a program manager, what’s your most valuable contribution to BD?

- A. Writing proposal sections when asked
- B. Proactively identifying recompute signals, customer pain points, and growth opportunities on your current contracts—and sharing them with BD
- C. Attending industry days
- D. Reviewing competitor websites

Your Answer:

Question 12 (BD-Delivery Coordination)

A proposal you supported just won. The delivery team is reviewing the proposal and finds a staffing commitment that will be difficult to meet. Who is responsible, and what should happen?

- A. BD’s responsibility—delivery shouldn’t have to deal with BD’s promises
- B. This is a shared responsibility—BD should have validated commitments with delivery during proposal development, and now both teams must collaborate on solutions
- C. Delivery’s problem now—BD moves to the next opportunity
- D. Renegotiate the contract immediately

Your Answer:

Question 13 (Executive Communication)

Your CEO has 5 minutes for a BD pipeline update. What should you communicate?

- A. Detailed status of every opportunity
- B. Top 3 opportunities, total pipeline value, win rate trend, key wins/losses, and one decision needed
- C. The full pipeline spreadsheet
- D. Only good news to keep them happy

Your Answer:

Question 14 (Knowledge Management)

Your company wins 30% of proposals but doesn't systematically capture lessons learned.

What organizational change would most improve win rate?

- A. Hire more BD staff
- B. Implement a formal win/loss analysis process with documented lessons that feed back into capture planning and training
- C. Buy more proposal tools
- D. Attend more conferences

Your Answer:

Question 15 (Culture Change)

Technical staff in your company say they're "too busy delivering" to support BD activities like customer meetings or proposal reviews. How do you address this?

- A. Excuse them—delivery is more important
- B. Work with leadership to tie BD contribution to performance reviews, allocate specific time for growth activities, and show how BD success enables job security and growth
- C. Do all BD work yourself
- D. Hire separate BD staff with no delivery responsibilities

Your Answer:

Section D: Strategic & Ethical Decision-Making (Questions 16-20)

Question 16 (Ethical Scenario)

During a customer meeting, a government employee offers to share the draft RFP before it's officially released. What should you do?

- A. Accept it—this gives you a competitive advantage
- B. Politely decline and document the interaction—accepting non-public procurement information could constitute an Organizational Conflict of Interest or procurement integrity violation
- C. Accept it but don't tell anyone
- D. Report the government employee to their supervisor

Your Answer:

Question 17 (OCI Scenario)

Your company is providing systems engineering support to an agency, helping define requirements for a future procurement. Can your company also bid on the resulting contract?

- A. Yes—prior work doesn't affect eligibility
- B. Potentially, but you must disclose the OCI, may need mitigation, and the agency must determine you didn't have unfair advantage in shaping requirements
- C. No—you're automatically disqualified
- D. Only if you wait 6 months

Your Answer:

Question 18 (Strategic Scenario)

Your company's 8(a) certification expires in 18 months. 60% of your revenue comes from 8(a) set-aside contracts. What strategic action is most important?

- A. Continue business as usual—you have 18 months
- B. Develop a transition strategy: pursue full-and-open opportunities, build past performance outside 8(a), explore mentor-protégé relationships, and diversify revenue sources
- C. Try to extend the 8(a) certification
- D. Sell the company before certification expires

Your Answer:

Question 19 (Pricing Strategy)

Your competitor is known for aggressive “buy-in” pricing—bidding below cost to win, then making up margin through change orders. How should this affect your strategy?

- A. Match their low prices
- B. Differentiate on value, risk mitigation, and total cost of ownership—some customers have learned that low-ball bids lead to problems
- C. Report them to the government
- D. Exit the market

Your Answer:

Question 20 (Leadership Scenario)

After losing a major recompetes, your team is demoralized. As BD leader, what's your first action?

- A. Blame the proposal team for the loss
- B. Acknowledge the loss, request a debrief to understand why, share lessons learned transparently, and refocus the team on the next pursuit
- C. Pretend it didn't happen and move on
- D. Fire the capture manager

Your Answer:

Answer Key

For Facilitator/Self-Grading Use Only

Q	Answer	Rationale
1	B	Pipeline math: revenue target ÷ win rate = required pipeline
2	B	Concentration creates risk; diversification protects revenue
3	B	Multi-factor scoring enables objective prioritization
4	B	Big pursuits require thorough risk-benefit analysis
5	B	Low win rate often indicates poor bid/no-bid discipline
6	B	Capture leads facilitate cross-functional solutions
7	B	Negotiate objectively but be willing to walk away
8	B	Address all stakeholder priorities with integrated messaging
9	B	Strategic exceptions require transparent leadership decision
10	B	Contingency execution, not hoping for extensions
11	B	Program staff are closest to recompete signals
12	B	BD-delivery is shared accountability
13	B	Executive briefings: key metrics + decision needed
14	B	Systematic lessons learned improve future performance
15	B	Culture change requires incentives and leadership support
16	B	Protect procurement integrity—decline non-public info
17	B	OCI requires disclosure and agency determination
18	B	8(a) graduation requires strategic transition planning
19	B	Compete on value, not race to the bottom
20	B	Leaders learn from losses and refocus teams

Scoring:

- 18-20 correct: Certified Professional—congratulations!
- 16-17 correct: Pass—review missed areas, panel review may explore gaps
- Below 16: Additional study required—retake after review

**Candidates scoring 16+ proceed to Capstone Project and Certification
Panel Review**

